PROJECT CONTINUITY SUMMARY

Dataset

Week 3 analysis continues using the Sample - Superstore.csv dataset that was used during Week 2. The dataset contains transactional information covering orders, customers, products, categories, sub-categories, regions, order dates, sales, quantities, discounts, and profit.

Business Problem

The objective is to dive deeper into the Week 2 analysis by determining what is driving sales and profitability across products, categories, regions, and customer segments. The analysis will also investigate underperforming areas, loss-making products and categories, the effect of discounting on profitability, and sales and profit trends over time.

The overall business question is:

Which areas of the business are driving sales and profit, which areas are underperforming, and what factors may be contributing to differences in performance?

Key Findings from Week 2

The Week 2 analysis established the following baseline:

- Total Sales: $2.30 million
- Total Profit: $286.40 thousand
- Overall Profit Margin: 12.47%
- Orders: 5,009
- Customers: 793
- Products: 1,862

The West region generated approximately $725,458 in sales and $108,418 in profit.

The Consumer segment was the largest contributor to sales and profit.

At category level, Technology generated the highest profit at approximately $145,455, while Furniture generated approximately $742,000 in sales but only $18,451 in profit, indicating a significant profitability concern.

At the sub-category level, Tables, Bookcases, and Supplies generated negative total profit.

2017 recorded the highest annual sales and profit.

Areas for Further Investigation

Based on the Week 2 findings, Week 3 will investigate:

1. Sales performance over time - monthly, quarterly and yearly trends and growth.
2. Profitability performance - profit and margin by category, sub-category and region.
3. High-sales/low-profit areas - particularly Furniture and its sub-categories.
4. Loss-making products and sub-categories - including Tables, Bookcases and Supplies.
5. Discount impact - whether higher discounts are associated with lower profitability.
6. Regional performance - particularly the profitability gap between stronger and weaker regions.
7. Customer and segment contribution - identifying the most valuable segments and customers.